

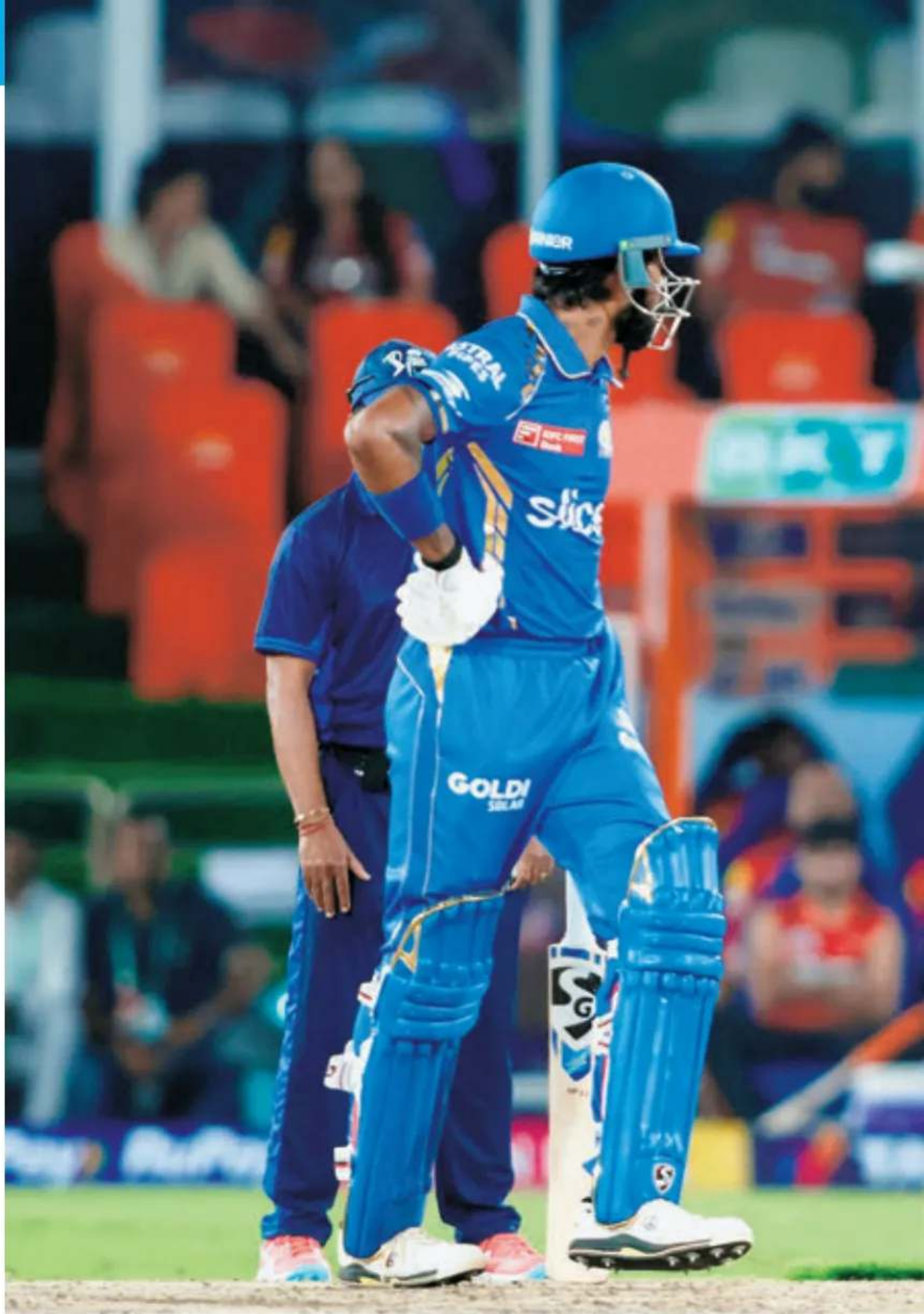
hands of the willow-yielders further, allowing teams to beef up the line-up with specialists.

To offer bowlers some respite, the tournament organisers decided to permit two bouncers in an over this year, doubling their capacity to opt for the short-pitched stuff. The decision came after the two-bouncer-per-over provision, trialled during the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy 2023–24 T20 tournament, received positive feedback.

The bowlers readily accepted the munificence and put it to work. **The short ball has gained increasing currency in the IPL, with its frequency rising from one in every 11 deliveries bowled by pacers in 2022 to one in every nine the following year.** With the cushion of bowlers being allowed an extra bouncer this year, the short ball recurred almost every five balls in the first 13 matches of this edition of the IPL.

"... the moment it was decided that there were going to be two bouncers in an over, that's when all the bowlers decided that we got to use it at a certain point.

"Someone who has pace can use those bouncers, but slower bouncers are working nowadays because the batsmen are trying to muscle the ball out of the ground, especially with the Impact Player rule. You have to use those variations in T20 and keep the batsmen guessing," Sunrisers Hyderabad seamer Jaydev Unadkat, who used the slower bouncer effectively against Chennai Super



Balls per wicket

